Weiting Hong

weiting.hong@yale.edu | weitinghong.com

Last Updated: October 26, 2026

Research Interests

Behavioral asset pricing, return predictability, financial text analysis and NLP

Education

Yale University, School of Management — New Haven, CT
Ph.D. in Financial Economics — Expected 05/2028

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.85/4.00
- **Relevant Coursework:** Financial Econometrics and Machine Learning, Behavioral Finance, Applied Empirical Methods, Macro Finance, Financial Economics, Corporate Finance, Macro (I, II, Adv), Micro (I, II), Industrial Organization I
- **Selective Research Programs:** 2026 Russell Sage Foundation Summer Inst. in Behavioral Economics, 2024 Yale Summer School in Behavioral Finance
- **Teaching Fellow:** Financial Econometrics (MAM Fall 2026), Behavioral Finance (MBA Spring 2025, Ph.D. Spring 2026), Entrepreneurial Finance (MBA Fall 2025), Financial Markets & Macro Policy (MBA Fall 2024)

Columbia University, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences — New York, NY
M.A. in Economics — 09/2021–12/2022

- **Cumulative GPA:** 4.14/4.00 | **GRE:** 340/340 | **CFA:** Passed Level I Exam in February 2022 (Top 10%)
- **Relevant Coursework:** Theory of International Trade (doctoral), Financial Economics, International Economics, Macro (I, II), Micro (I, II), Econometrics (I, II), Math Methods for Economists
- **Honors:** Program for Economic Research (PER) Summer Fellow

New York University, Leonard N. Stern School of Business — New York, NY
B.S. in Business (Statistics & Finance) — 09/2018–08/2021

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.99/4.00 (summa cum laude, Dean's List) | **SAT:** 1590/1600 | **ACT:** 36/36 | **AIME:** 7
- **Relevant Coursework:** Stochastic Processes, Theory of Probability, Real Analysis, Linear Algebra, Statistical Inference and Regression, Quantitative Microeconomics, Debt Instruments, Equity Valuation (High school: Multivariable Calculus, AP Calculus BC, AP Physics C)
- **Honors:** 2020 Sequoia Investment Pitch Comp. 1st Pl., 2020 Point72 Case Comp. 2nd Pl., 2019 Powder Gate Stock Pitch Comp. 3rd Pl.

Working Papers

Selective Recall and the Story-Statistics Gap in Stock Market Misreaction

Data & Methods: Capital IQ and Reuters MRN news data; NLP and text embeddings; LLM-assisted annotation; signal construction; event studies; return prediction and portfolio tests

Abstract: I document a strong story-statistics gap in stock market misreaction to corporate news: whereas qualitative announcements exhibit mild overreaction, quantitative announcements generate pronounced underreaction. This pattern cannot be fully explained by signal-strength uncertainty, diagnostic expectations, news sentiment, or investor attention. Motivated by experimental evidence on selective recall, I hypothesize that memory evaluates similarity based on different characteristics for stories and for statistics. I propose that stories are similar within each news category due to shared narrative features, while statistics with comparable stock price impact are similar across news categories due to their numerical precision. Model-predicted misreactions under my hypothesized similarity patterns strongly align with the empirically observed story-statistics gap across news categories. I additionally find strong, measurement error-free support for my model in announcement-level data. In line with the hypothesized similarity structure, I show that news announcements that are more similar in quantitativeness generate more comparable stock price impacts.

Conferences: 2027 American Finance Association (AFA) Annual Meeting, 2026 USC Marshall Ph.D. Conference in Finance, 2026 Johns Hopkins University Annual Carey Finance Conference

Information Leakage Prior to SEC Form Filings: Evidence from *TAQ*

With Steven Wei Ho and Mingrui Zhang

Data & Methods: Millisecond Trades-and-Quotes (TAQ) data; SEC filings; RavenPack news data; market microstructure measures; signal construction; event studies; return prediction and portfolio tests

Abstract: Using *TAQ* data around trading-hour SEC filings from 2003 to 2024, we document a pre-announcement drift across EDGAR acceptance timestamps: when firms experience significant cash-flow news, 30-minute pre-acceptance returns positively predict 30-minute post-acceptance returns. Momentum, investor attention, recent firm-specific news, and contemporaneous market-wide movements do not explain the pattern; and this pattern would disappear if genuine filing date-times are replaced by placebo with random date-times. Extreme pre-acceptance returns coincide with elevated abnormal volume, informed-trading risk, and directional order flow, and the drift strengthens with SEC enforcement caseload. Our evidence is consistent with filing information reaching prices before public dissemination.

Conferences: 2020 American Finance Association (AFA) Ph.D. Student Poster Session, 2024 Midwest Finance Association, 2024 INFORMS Annual Meeting

Refereed Publication

Hong, Weiting (2022). "Trade momentum for alpha". *Finance Research Letters* 50, p. 103300

Data & Methods: Citation-share measures derived from 10-K filings; export-volume and trade-barrier data; signal construction; return prediction and portfolio tests

Abstract: I provide new evidence on the value-relevance of international trade development, the heterogeneous distribution of foreign economic benefits among market participants, and the value-add of additional geographic information disclosure by designing the Trade Momentum Index with publicly available citation share, export volume, and trade barrier data. Using a sample of 13,016 firm-year combinations of goods-exporting U.S. firms between 2008 and 2020, I find that a Trade Momentum Index-based, equal-weight hedge portfolio generates a statistically significant annualized alpha of 17.42% at a Sharpe ratio of 0.8255. This result exhibits robustness as the abnormal returns persist under different factor models.

Additional Research

Effect of Information Asymmetry on the Performance of Small and Young Firms

The Pricing and Positive Externality of Trade Finance amid Uncertainties in Global Value Chains — Master's Thesis

Research Experience

Columbia University Program for Economic Research — New York, NY
Research Assistant for Professors Donald R. Davis and Tomasz Michalski — 05/2022–09/2022
- Examined the spatial dimension of unemployment dynamics by aggregating individual responses from the Current Population Survey
- Analyzed central vs. outskirt, large vs. small labor market differences at the MSA level after controlling for various demographic features

Columbia Business School Economics Department — New York, NY
Research Assistant for Professor Shang-Jin Wei — 03/2022–12/2022
- Analyzed the differences in disclosure standards among stock exchanges to assess the impact of the regulatory environment on asset valuation
- Compared the return volatility and shock responses of cross-listed equity shares with those of firms listed on only one stock exchange

The World in 2050 — New York, NY
Research Assistant for Professor Jeffrey D. Sachs — 09/2021–09/2022
- Developed integrated pathways for achieving the SDGs worldwide by 2050 by building a dynamic general equilibrium model in GAMS
- Numerically estimated the impact of higher sovereign debt limits and lower interest rates on the development of low-income countries

Professional Experience

Citigroup Global Markets, Inc. — New York, NY
Healthcare Investment Banking Analyst — 02/2023–06/2023
- Researched client financing needs throughout the clinical development process and covered 16 accounts across a variety of healthcare verticals
- Performed detailed due diligence and comprehensive valuation exercises (Comps, DCF, SOTP, LBO) to inform client decision-making

Citigroup Global Markets, Inc. — New York, NY
Healthcare Investment Banking Summer Analyst — 06/2021–08/2021
- Worked on nine client accounts in the biopharma and medical devices sectors, including M&A pitches, crossover transactions, and IPO bake-offs
- Managed and attended over 40 investor and client calls and contributed to team decision-making by taking detailed notes on discussions

Madison Avenue Partners, LP — New York, NY
Investment Analyst Intern — 07/2019–12/2019
- Conducted equity research on domestic and foreign companies to evaluate various special-situation and value investment opportunities
- Built detailed financial projection models, organized calls with equity research analysts and industry experts, and constructed equity screeners

Skills

Programming: R, Python
Machine Learning & NLP: LLMs, text embeddings, scikit-learn, Hugging Face/Transformers
Research & Data: WRDS, CRSP, TAQ, Capital IQ Key Developments, Reuters MRN, Bloomberg, FactSet
Other: Stata, SAS, MATLAB, Java, GAMS, Excel
Languages: English (Fluent), Chinese (Native)